

Serve people to earn the right to lead them

Many of us focus on the routines of life: **waking up**, getting dressed, eating breakfast, driving to work or class, working to earn a living, coming home, and repeating the cycle the following day. Some among us **wonder** if that is all there is to human **existence**. Those who raise this question **conclude** that there is a higher power within us that guides us.

We **possess** the characteristics, behaviour, and habits of mind and heart of true leaders. True leaders have the **courage** to **confront** the meaning of existence. They have the courage to live in a manner that offers meaning to others; they inspire hope in others that they too can become one of God's **noble** works. Such leaders **radiate unmatched** strength of character and **will**. Yet, they are the most humble and **compassionate** of leaders.

Leadership is a **reflection** of who we are within. It has two central **aspects**: understanding our true self and serving others. True leaders enter within their own hearts and souls, engage in self-analysis, and connect with the spiritual force within themselves. That inner spiritual power is the source of **virtues**, power, and life. Once we contact the **eternal** spiritual power, we connect with the source of the qualities of true leaders. This automatically and effortlessly **results in inculcating** the virtues and characteristics **associated** with great leaders.

Great leaders in history have said that service before self was the key to a full and rewarding life. It is by serving others that we earn the right to lead them. We may act as leaders, but we must be servants to lead meaningfully. The **role** of the leader and servant **cannot** be separated. A life of service is based on deep spiritual principles that are understood and **internalised** when we contact the Truth within.

How can we contact the spiritual power that connects us with the source of true leadership and **embody** leadership that is **lasting** and inspiring?

It is by **tapping into** the source of spiritual power within. We call this process prayer with attention, concentration, or meditation. When we withdraw our attention from the outer world and focus it within, we **embark on** the inner, spiritual journey to experience God's **love and Light**. As we connect with the **Divine** love and **awaken** to our own true nature as soul, which is a part of the Divine, we recognise His presence in all living creatures. With this comes the understanding that we are all connected through His love. Then we open our hearts to everyone and **seek** to serve people selflessly.

We need dedication and **perseverance** to achieve anything. For those who turn toward the spiritual path, true leadership will come without fail. We do not need to act or pose. Our leadership and spiritual strength will flow from our words and actions and will reach the hearts of others as naturally and **inevitably** as a stream flows towards its source. If we tap into the spiritual resources within, we will become leaders whose lives will inspire others to follow and who will be a **blessing** to those we meet.

Leadership is a product of deep, ongoing self-analysis. It is about choosing a life **committed** to spiritual growth and service.

Summary of the Editorial

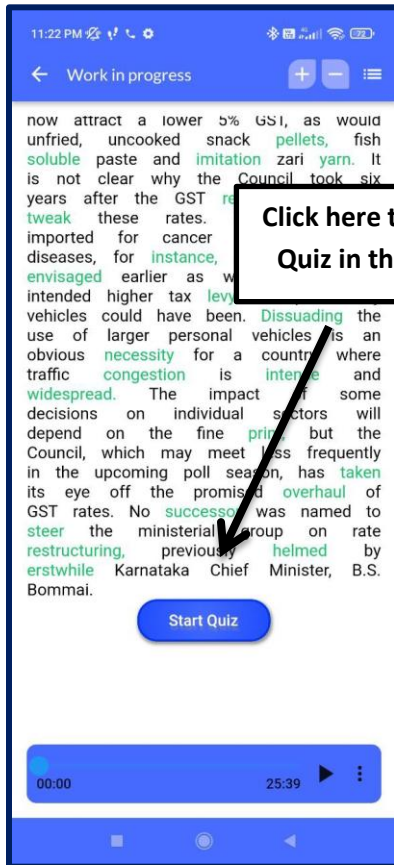
1. **Life's Routine:** The editorial begins by describing the mundane routines of daily life and raises the question of whether there is more to human existence.
2. **Quest for Meaning:** It suggests that those questioning life's routine feel a call towards a higher purpose and leadership.
3. **Definition of True Leaders:** True leaders are portrayed as individuals who confront existential questions and inspire others by living meaningful lives.
4. **Inner Strength and Humility:** Such leaders possess a strong character and will, yet remain humble and compassionate.
5. **Leadership as Self-Reflection:** Leadership is explained as a reflection of our inner self, requiring understanding of our true nature and serving others.
6. **Spiritual Connection:** Leaders are said to connect with an inner spiritual power, which is the source of their virtues and leadership qualities.
7. **Service Before Self:** Historical leaders emphasized that service is key to a fulfilling life, stating that by serving others, one earns the right to lead.
8. **Inseparability of Leadership and Service:** The roles of leader and servant are intertwined, with meaningful leadership stemming from genuine service.
9. **Contacting Spiritual Power:** The editorial discusses how to access the spiritual power within through prayer, meditation, or focused attention.
10. **Spiritual Journey:** By focusing inward, individuals can embark on a spiritual journey, experiencing divine love and recognizing their true nature as part of the divine.
11. **Recognition of Unity:** This inward focus leads to a realization of the interconnectedness of all living beings through divine love.
12. **Selfless Service:** With a new understanding of unity, individuals are encouraged to serve others selflessly, opening their hearts to all.
13. **Natural Leadership:** The piece asserts that true leadership and spiritual strength emerge naturally from one's actions and words, influencing others effortlessly.
14. **Leadership as Ongoing Self-Analysis:** It emphasizes that leadership requires continuous self-analysis and a commitment to spiritual growth and service.
15. **Impact of Leadership:** Ultimately, leaders who tap into their spiritual resources inspire others, becoming blessings to those they meet and leading by example.

Vocabulary

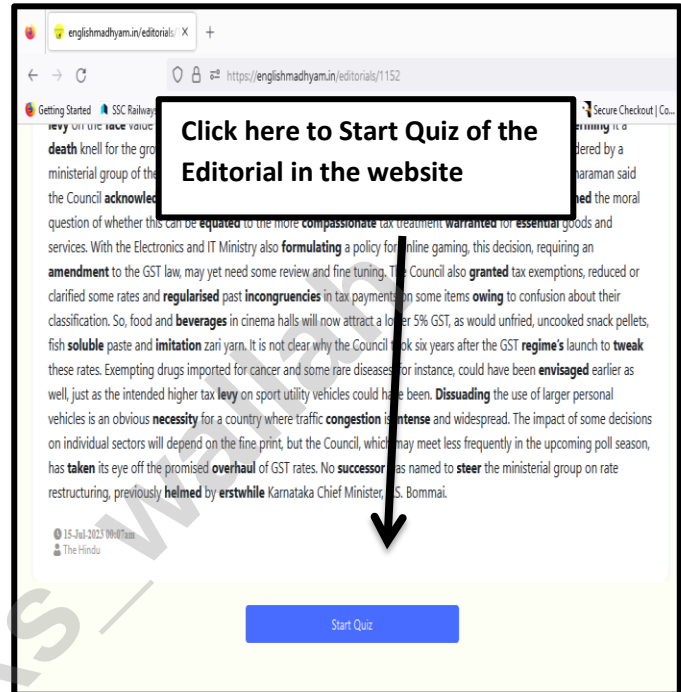
1. **Waking up** (noun) – Awakening, rousing, arising, getting up, stirring जागना
2. **Wonder** (verb) – Ponder, speculate, question, marvel, inquire आश्चर्य करना
3. **Existence** (noun) – Being, life, presence, reality, subsistence अस्तित्व
4. **Conclude** (verb) – Deduce, infer, decide, determine, resolve निष्कर्ष निकालना
5. **Possess** (verb) – Have, own, hold, control, retain रखना
6. **Courage** (noun) – Bravery, valor, boldness, guts, heroism साहस
7. **Confront** (verb) – Face, challenge, oppose, meet, encounter सामना करना
8. **Noble** (adjective) – Honorable, dignified, illustrious, virtuous, distinguished महान
9. **Radiate** (verb) – Emit, emanate, shine, spread, glow प्रसारित करना
10. **Unmatched** (adjective) – Unrivaled, unparalleled, unequalled, incomparable, peerless बेजोड़
11. **Will** (noun) – Determination, resolve, intention, desire, purpose इच्छाशक्ति
12. **Compassionate** (adjective) – Caring, kind, merciful, sympathetic, empathetic दयालु
13. **Reflection** (noun) – Thought, contemplation, deliberation, meditation, pondering चिंतन
14. **Aspect** (noun) – Facet, angle, feature, side, dimension पहलू
15. **Virtue** (noun) – Goodness, morality, integrity, righteousness, ethics सद्गुण
16. **Eternal** (adjective) – Everlasting, perpetual, immortal, unending, infinite शाश्वत
17. **Result in** (phrasal verb) – Lead to, cause, bring about, produce, effect परिणाम होना
18. **Inculcate** (verb) – Instill, implant, infuse, instigate, imbue मस्तिष्क में बैठा देना, समझाना
19. **Associated** (with) (adjective) – Connected, related, linked, affiliated, allied संबद्ध
20. **Internalise** (verb) – Absorb, assimilate, integrate, incorporate, adopt आत्मसात करना
21. **Embody** (verb) – Personify, represent, express, incarnate, manifest साकार करना
22. **Lasting** (adjective) – Durable, enduring, permanent, long-lasting, persistent स्थायी
23. **Tap into** (phrasal verb) – Access, utilize, exploit, draw from, harness लाभ उठाना

24. **Embark on** (phrasal verb) – Begin, initiate, start, commence, launch आरंभ करना
25. **Love and light** (noun) – Spiritual affection and illumination, divine warmth and brightness, celestial love and enlightenment दिव्य प्रेम और ज्योति
26. **Divine** (noun) – Godly, heavenly, celestial, supreme, sacred दिव्य
27. **Awaken** (adjective) – Aware, conscious, alert, enlightened, awakened जागृत
28. **Seek** (verb) – endeavour, effort, attempt, try प्रयास करना
29. **Perseverance** (noun) – Persistence, determination, endurance, steadfastness, tenacity निरन्तर प्रयत्न
30. **Inevitably** (adjective) – Unavoidably, necessarily, inescapably, certainly, surely अनिवार्य रूप से
31. **Blessing** (noun) – Favor, boon, benefit, grace, advantage आशीर्वाद
32. **Committed (to)** (adjective) – Dedicated, devoted, loyal, faithful, engaged समर्पित

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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